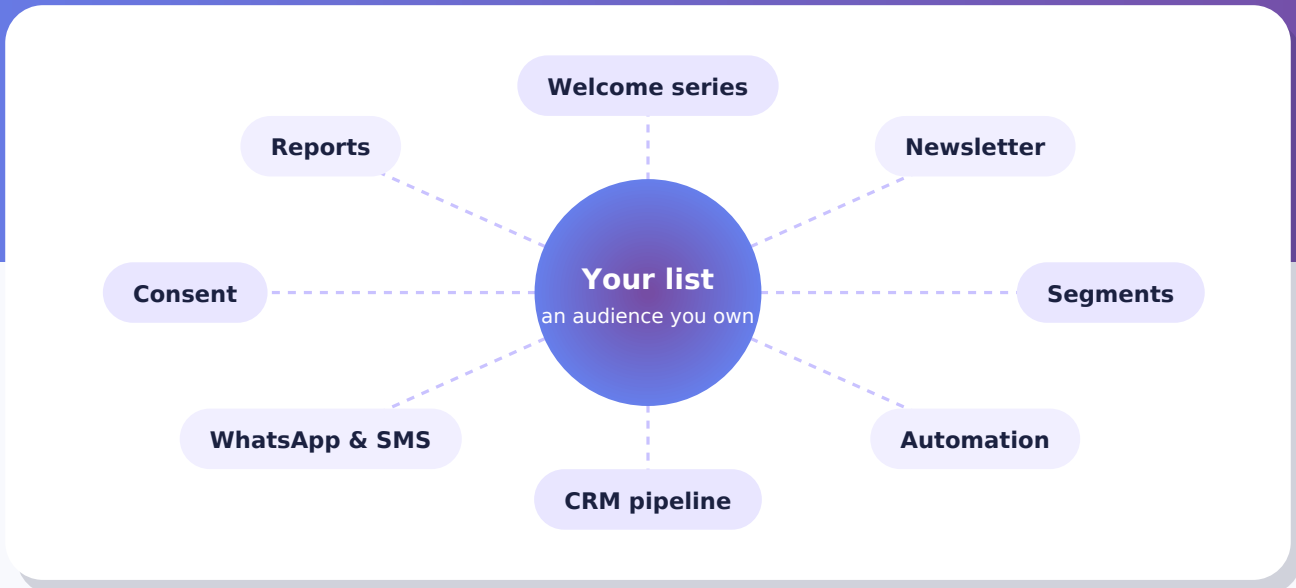
WEEK 10 · DIGITAL MARKETING & AI BOOTCAMP

Email Marketing & CRM

Lists, consent, automation, segmentation and CRM for businesses in Mauritius, step by step

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PART A

Foundations

Why email and CRM matter, how they work, and the rules on consent in Mauritius and the EU

SECTION 1

Why email and CRM: the channel you own

Email marketing means sending planned, useful messages to people who have agreed to hear from you. A CRM (Customer Relationship Management) system is the database where you keep every contact, their history and their deals. Together they turn one-off buyers into repeat customers.

Rented reach vs an audience you own

Social platforms can change the rules overnight. Your email list and CRM stay with you.

RENTED

Social media followers

- The platform decides who sees your post
- Organic reach can drop without warning
- Accounts can be hacked or blocked
- You cannot export your followers
- Great for discovery and community

OWNED

Email list + CRM

- You decide who receives what, and when
- Every subscriber gave you permission
- You can export and move your data
- History of every contact in one place
- Best for loyalty, repeat sales and follow-up

Owned, earned and paid media

In Week 4 you met the PESO model (Paid, Earned, Shared, Owned). Your website and your email list are the two most important **owned** assets. On Facebook, Instagram or TikTok (Week 5) you build an audience on someone else's land: the algorithm decides how many followers see each post, and your page could be hacked or restricted. An email list is different. Each subscriber gave you permission to write to them, and you can export the list and take it to another tool at any time.

	Social media (organic)	Paid ads	Email + CRM
Who controls reach	The platform algorithm	Your budget	You
Cost per message	Free, but uncertain reach	Pay for every view or click	Low: a tool subscription
Best job	Discovery, community	Fast reach to new people	Loyalty, repeat sales, follow-up
Personalisation	Limited	By audience	By person: name, history, behaviour
If you stop paying or posting	Reach drops	Results stop	The list stays yours

What email and CRM do for a business

- **Bring customers back:** a birthday reminder, a seasonal menu or a "we miss you" email costs almost nothing compared with finding a new customer through ads.
- **Follow up leads properly:** no more enquiries lost in a notebook or a WhatsApp chat. Every lead has an owner, a stage and a next step.
- **Personalise at scale:** send families one message and couples another, automatically.
- **Work while you sleep:** automations (welcome series, post-purchase, win-back) run every day without you.

- **Measure clearly:** you see who opened, who clicked and who bought, and you can link email to sales in GA4 (Week 2).

> **The mindset:** your email list is a group of people who raised their hand and said "keep me informed". Treat that permission like a gift: send less, but send things they are happy to receive.

SECTION 2

How email marketing and CRM work together

Before you open a tool, understand the building blocks. Most email platforms and CRMs use the same ideas, even if the names change from one tool to another.

Building block	What it is	Example
ESP (Email Service Provider)	The tool that stores your list and sends bulk emails safely	Mailchimp, Brevo, MailerLite, HubSpot
Audience / list	All your contacts in the tool. Keep one main list and split it with tags and segments	Lakaz Gato customers
Contact properties (fields)	Information stored about each contact	First name, town, birthday, language
Tags	Labels you add to contacts	source_shop, wedding_lead, vip
Segment	A saved filter that updates automatically	Clicked in the last 90 days AND lives in the North
Campaign (broadcast)	One email sent to many people at a chosen time	October newsletter
Automation (flow, journey, workflow)	Emails sent automatically when a trigger happens	Welcome series after sign-up
Form	Where people join the list	Website pop-up, landing page, QR code form
CRM	The database of contacts, companies and deals, with the full history of each relationship	HubSpot free CRM

Campaigns vs automations

A **campaign** is like a newspaper: everyone on the chosen list receives it at the same time. An **automation** is like a personal assistant: it reacts to what one person does (joins, buys, has a birthday, stops opening) and sends the right message at the right moment. Successful programmes use both: a regular campaign rhythm plus a few automations that run in the background.

Email tool vs CRM

An email tool is built to **send**; a CRM is built to **manage relationships**, especially sales conversations (calls, quotes, meetings, deals). Small businesses selling online or in a shop often start with an email tool only. Businesses with a sales process (B2B services, training, events, weddings, real estate, car dealers) need a CRM to track each lead. Many tools now do both: HubSpot is a CRM with email; Mailchimp and Brevo are email tools with basic CRM features.

> **Tip:** Keep **one** main audience in your email tool and organise it with tags and segments. Several separate lists create duplicates, you pay twice for the same person, and unsubscribes in one list are not applied to the others.

SECTION 3

Email in Mauritius: what is different

Mauritius is a small, mobile-first market where people mix English, French and Kreol, and where WhatsApp is the main conversation channel. Email still has an important place, but you must adapt your approach.

Who uses email and for what

- **Professionals and B2B:** email is still the main channel for quotes, proposals, invoices, training and events. LinkedIn (Week 5) and email work well together.
- **Consumers:** people read emails on their phones, between WhatsApp messages. Short, visual emails with one clear action work best.
- **Tourism:** hotels, guesthouses and tour operators email many foreign visitors (France, Réunion, the UK, Germany, South Africa, India...) before and after their stay. That brings EU rules into play (Section 4).
- **Transactional emails:** bank alerts, bookings, receipts and deliveries train people to open emails from companies they know.

Language

Write in the language your customers use with you. Many Mauritian businesses send in English or French, sometimes both. A simple approach: ask for the preferred language on the sign-up form and segment by it. Kreol works well in short subject lines and friendly touches, but keep important information (prices, dates, conditions) clear in English or French.

Local moments for your email calendar

Period	Ideas
January–February	New Year, Chinese Spring Festival, Thaipoosam Cavadee, back to school
March–April	National Day (12 March), Ougadi, Easter
May–June	Labour Day, Mother’s Day, Father’s Day, start of winter
August–September	Ganesh Chaturthi, spring menus and new collections
October–November	Divali, Black Friday, end-of-year events, wedding season
December	Christmas, year-end gifts, summer school holidays

Religious and cultural festival dates change every year. Check the official list of public holidays before you plan.

> **In Mauritius:** the market is small and word of mouth is powerful. A badly targeted email blast quickly becomes "that company that spams me". A list of 800 local customers who open and buy is worth more than 20,000 bought addresses that damage your reputation and break the law.

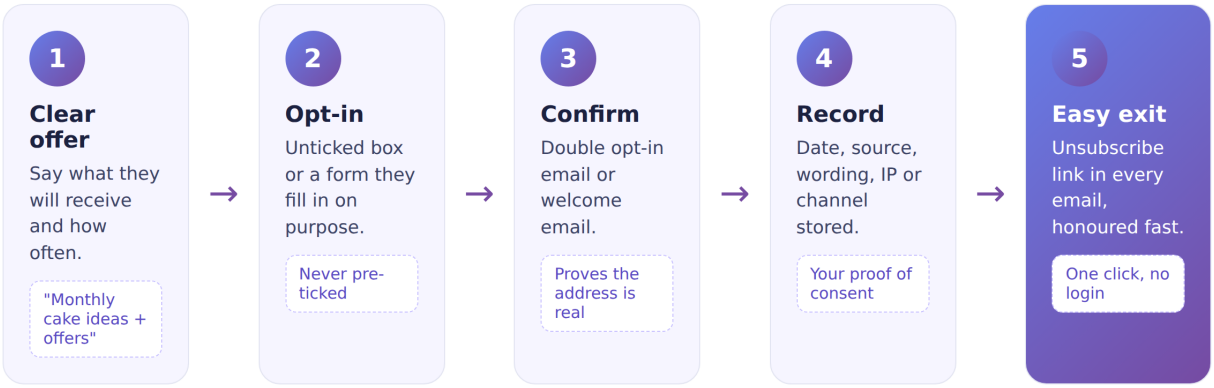
SECTION 4

Consent and the law: Mauritius and the EU

Before you send a single marketing email, make sure you have the right to. In Mauritius the main law is the Data Protection Act 2017 (DPA 2017), supervised by the Data Protection Office. When you email people in the European Union, the GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation) can also apply. This section is practical guidance, not legal advice.

The consent journey for every subscriber

Mauritius Data Protection Act 2017: you must be able to prove consent



What the Data Protection Act 2017 says

Rule	Where in the Act	What it means for email
Consent must be freely given, specific, informed and unambiguous	Section 2 (definition)	A clear opt-in for marketing. No pre-ticked boxes, no "by buying you agree to receive offers".
The controller must prove consent	Section 24(1)	Keep records: date, source, form wording, what they agreed to.
Consent can be withdrawn at any time	Section 24(2)	Unsubscribe in every email; process it quickly.
Right to object to direct marketing	Section 40	If someone objects, you must stop using their data for marketing.
Registration of controllers	Section 14	Businesses that process personal data must register with the Data Protection Commissioner.
Breach notification	Section 25	Tell the Commissioner without undue delay and, where feasible, within 72 hours.
Offences	Section 43	General penalty: a fine of up to Rs 200,000 and imprisonment of up to 5 years.

Practical rules for every list

1. **Opt-in only.** Add people who actively agreed to receive marketing. An unticked box or a sign-up form is fine; a business card dropped in a bowl is not enough unless the card or form says so.

2. **Say what they get.** "Monthly news and offers from Lakaz Gato. Unsubscribe at any time." Link to your privacy notice.
3. **Collect only what you need.** Email and first name are enough to start. Add birthday or town only if you will use them.
4. **Use double opt-in** when lists come from public forms: the person clicks a confirmation link. It proves the address is real and that they asked.
5. **Never buy, rent or scrape lists.** It breaks consent rules, damages deliverability and Gmail or Outlook will send you to spam.
6. **Unsubscribe in every marketing email,** plus a preference centre if possible (less often, only offers, other language).
7. **Keep proof:** most tools store the sign-up date, source and IP address. Export it from time to time.
8. **Protect the data:** strong passwords and two-factor authentication on the email tool and CRM; give access only to people who need it.

Customers vs prospects

Transactional emails (receipt, booking confirmation, delivery update) do not need marketing consent because they are part of the service. But do not slip promotions into them. If a customer wants your newsletter, ask them with a clear checkbox at checkout or at the counter.

When the GDPR applies

The GDPR can apply to a Mauritian business that offers goods or services to people in the EU, for example a hotel emailing French or German guests before their stay, or an online shop that delivers to Réunion. In practice the same habits protect you under both laws: clear opt-in, proof of consent, easy unsubscribe, a clear privacy notice and secure data. Many email tools offer GDPR fields on forms (marketing permissions) that you can switch on.

> **WhatsApp and SMS follow the same logic.** Only send marketing messages to people who agreed to receive them on that channel, and always give a simple way to stop (for example "Reply STOP"). Meta’s WhatsApp Business rules also require opt-in before businesses send messages.

PART B

Strategy & planning

Your email strategy, list building,
the main email types and
a realistic sending calendar

SECTION 5

The email strategy in six questions

An email strategy is a short plan that says why you send emails, to whom, what you send, how often, with which tool and how you will measure success. It does not need to be long: two pages are enough for most small businesses.

Question	What to decide	Example: Lakaz Gato (cake shop, Rose Hill)
1. Why?	One business goal and 2–3 SMART email objectives (Week 1)	Grow repeat orders: 25% of orders from returning customers within 6 months
2. Who?	Personas and segments (Week 4)	Parents planning birthdays; couples planning weddings; offices ordering for events
3. What?	Content pillars and email types	Monthly newsletter, birthday reminder, seasonal offers, post-order thank-you
4. How often?	A rhythm you can keep for a year	2 campaigns a month + 4 automations
5. With what?	Tool, forms, CRM, integrations	Mailchimp or Brevo + website form + QR code in the shop
6. How do we know?	KPIs, targets, reporting	Click rate, orders from email (GA4 key events), list growth, unsubscribes

Setting good email objectives

Link every objective to a business result, not just to opens. Good examples:

- Grow the list from 400 to 1,200 opted-in contacts by June, with at least 60% local customers.
- Generate Rs 150,000 of online orders from email in the next quarter (tracked in GA4 with UTMs).
- Convert 15% of new subscribers into first-time buyers within 30 days with a welcome series.
- Reactivate 10% of customers who have not ordered in 6 months with a win-back sequence.

These figures are illustrative targets. Set your own from your current numbers.

Your value promise

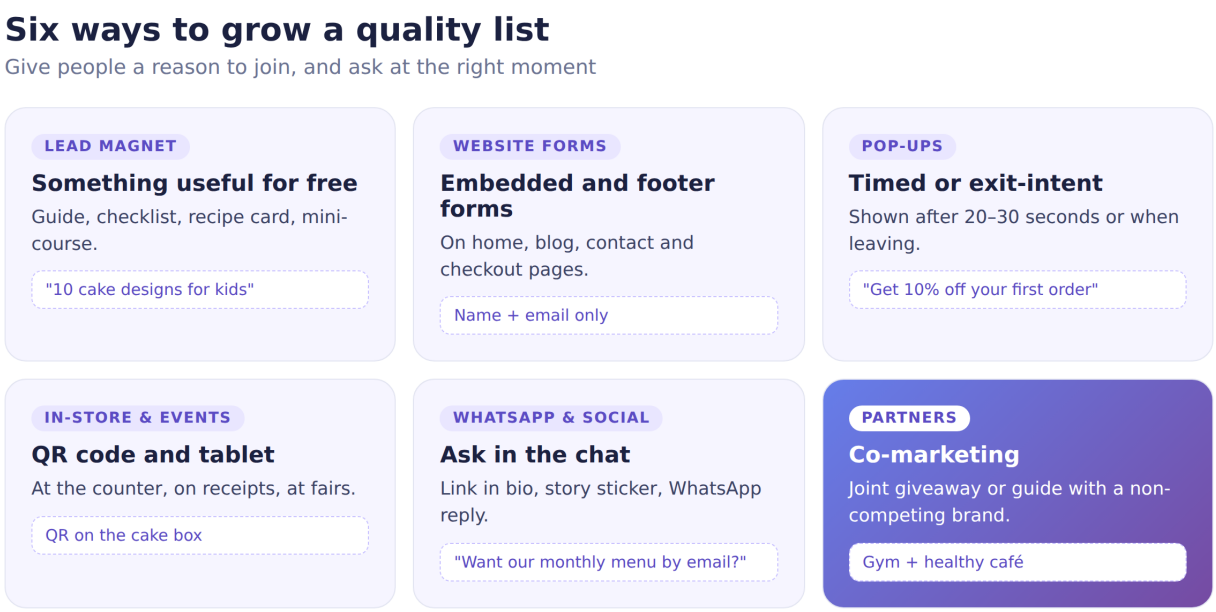
People do not want "a newsletter". They want something useful. Write one sentence that explains what subscribers get and why it is worth it, and use it on every form: "*Once a month: new cake designs, seasonal flavours and subscriber-only offers. No spam, unsubscribe in one click.*"

> **Tip:** look at the questions customers ask on WhatsApp, Messenger and at the counter (Week 4). Each frequent question is a ready-made email topic.

SECTION 6

Building your list the right way

A good list is built slowly, from people who know you and want to hear from you. The aim is not the biggest list, but the most engaged one.



Lead magnets that work in Mauritius

Business	Lead magnet idea
Cake shop	"10 kids' birthday cake ideas + price guide" (PDF) or 10% off the first order
Guesthouse	"The North Coast insider guide: beaches, restaurants, buses" (PDF)
Gym	Free trial class + "4-week beginner plan"
Training company	Free webinar or "AI prompts for small businesses" checklist
Real estate agent	"Buying property in Mauritius as a foreigner: 7 steps" guide
Restaurant	Birthday dessert offer + monthly menu

Where to place sign-up forms

- **Website:** footer form on every page, a dedicated sign-up page, a box at the end of blog posts, a checkbox at checkout (unticked).
- **Pop-up:** after 20–30 seconds, on scroll or exit intent. Show it once per visitor and make it easy to close on mobile. Google may treat intrusive pop-ups that cover content on mobile as a poor experience (Week 3).
- **Social:** link in bio, Instagram story link sticker, pinned Facebook post, LinkedIn newsletter or event form.
- **In-store:** a QR code at the counter, on receipts, on packaging and on table cards, leading to a short mobile form.
- **Events and fairs:** a tablet with your form (not a paper sheet that someone must retype).
- **WhatsApp:** when a customer orders, ask: "Would you like our monthly menu and offers by email?" If yes, send the form link, so they opt in themselves.

A good sign-up form

- A clear headline with the benefit ("Get our monthly cake ideas").
- As few fields as possible: email, first name, maybe language or birthday month.
- A sentence about frequency and a link to the privacy notice.
- A thank-you page or message that confirms and delivers the promise right away.

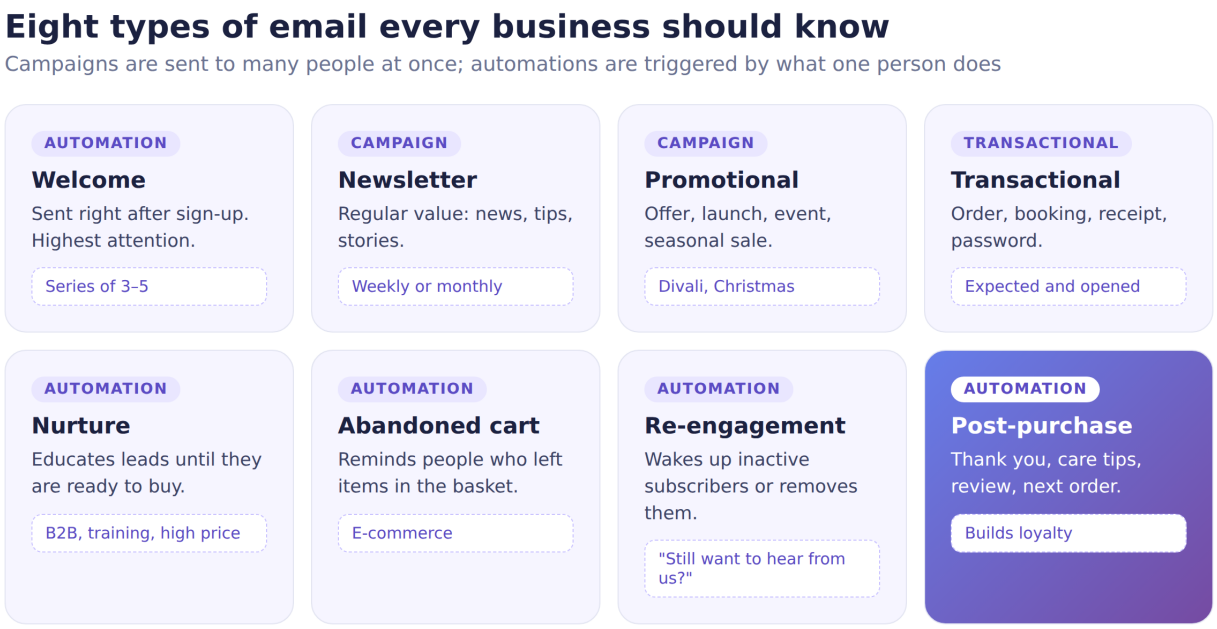
Never import phone contacts, WhatsApp group members, LinkedIn connections or business cards into your email tool without consent. Most email platforms forbid it in their terms, and complaints can get your account suspended.

In Mauritius: a QR code on the cake box or the hotel room card works well because people are already happy with what they bought. Add a small incentive ("Get a free cupcake on your next order") and a clear promise.

SECTION 7

The main types of email

Each email type has a different job. A healthy programme mixes regular campaigns with a few automations that run on their own.



Type	Trigger or timing	Goal	Tips
Welcome	Right after sign-up	Deliver the promise, introduce the brand, first purchase	Usually the most opened email you will ever send. Send it immediately.
Newsletter	Weekly, fortnightly or monthly	Stay top of mind with useful content	80% value, 20% promotion. One main story.
Promotional	Launches, sales, events, seasons	Sales and bookings	Clear offer, deadline, one CTA. Do not over-send.
Transactional	An order, booking, payment, password	Confirm and inform	Clear, fast, branded. No hidden promotions.

Type	Trigger or timing	Goal	Tips
Nurture	After a lead shows interest	Educate until ready to buy	Useful for high-value or B2B purchases.
Abandoned cart / browse	Items left in the basket	Recover the sale	Needs an online shop connected to the email tool (Week 16).
Post-purchase	After delivery or check-out	Thank, review, cross-sell, loyalty	Ask for a Google review (Week 3).
Re-engagement / win-back	No opens, clicks or orders for a period	Reactivate or clean the list	Remove people who still do not respond.

The 80/20 rule for newsletters

If every email is "Buy now!", people stop opening. Aim for mostly useful content (tips, stories, behind the scenes, local guides, customer stories) with a smaller share of offers. The useful emails build the trust that makes the offers work.

SECTION 8

Planning: frequency and the email calendar

Consistency matters more than volume. Choose a rhythm you can keep, plan it in your content calendar (Week 4) and protect your subscribers from too many messages.

How often should you send?

Business type	Typical rhythm to start
Shop, restaurant, bakery	2–4 campaigns a month + automations
Hotel, guesthouse, tour operator	1–2 a month + pre-arrival and post-stay emails
B2B services, training	1–2 a month (newsletter, event invitation) + nurture sequences
E-commerce	1–2 a week in busy seasons, with segmentation to avoid fatigue

These are starting points. If unsubscribes or complaints rise, send less or segment more. Avoid two promotions in the same week to the same people.

Build a 3-month email calendar

1. List the key dates for your business (Section 3) and your own launches or events.
2. Plan one campaign theme for each send date, linked to a content pillar.
3. Add the automations that run in the background (welcome, birthday, post-purchase).
4. Prepare emails 1 week ahead: copy, images, links with UTMs (Week 2), test send.
5. Book a monthly review to look at results and adjust the plan.

Date	Segment	Type	Subject line idea	Goal / KPI
Thu 6 Nov	All subscribers	Newsletter	Our Divali sweets are back	Clicks to menu
Thu 20 Nov	Customers (bought in last 12 months)	Promotion	Order your Christmas log early, get 10% off	Pre-orders
Thu 4 Dec	Office contacts	Promotion	End-of-year office party? We deliver	Quote requests

Date	Segment	Type	Subject line idea	Goal / KPI
Always on	New subscribers	Welcome series	5 emails over 14 days	First order

Example calendar lines for Lakaz Gato (illustrative).

> **Tip:** for local consumers, test early morning and lunchtime; for B2B, mid-morning on weekdays. Your own results (Section 26) are the best guide.

Let subscribers choose: the preference centre

A preference centre is a page linked from the footer where subscribers can change what they receive instead of leaving completely. Most email tools offer one (Mailchimp: groups or the update-profile page; HubSpot: subscription types; Brevo and MailerLite: preference or unsubscribe pages). Offer simple choices:

- **Topics:** kids’ birthday cakes, wedding cakes, office orders, recipes and tips.
- **Frequency:** every email, or a monthly summary only.
- **Language:** English or French.
- **Pause:** "Pause emails for 3 months" (useful after a wedding or a holiday).

Every choice becomes a group, tag or property you can use in segments (Section 16). Fewer people unsubscribe, and the ones who stay receive emails they really want.

> **Quick check:** can a subscriber change their topics, frequency or language in under 30 seconds from any email you send? If not, add a preference link next to the unsubscribe link.

PART C

Write, design, send

Tools, subject lines, copy, design, your first campaign and how to reach the inbox

SECTION 9

Choosing your email tool and CRM

There is no perfect tool, only the right one for your size, budget and needs. Free plans are fine to learn and to start, but their limits changed several times in 2026, so always check the pricing page before you commit.

Tool	Free plan (checked October 2026)	Strengths	Watch out
Mailchimp	250 contacts, 500 sends a month (max 250 a day), 1 user, 1 audience	Well known, easy editor, many integrations, good reports	Multi-step automation flows need a paid plan (Essentials: flows up to 4 steps; Standard: more)
HubSpot (free CRM + marketing tools)	Free CRM for up to 2 users; 2,000 marketing emails a month; forms, live chat, landing pages, 1 meetings link; HubSpot branding	A real CRM: contacts, companies, deals, pipeline, tasks, email tracking	Contact and template limits on new free accounts; automation and lead scoring are mostly in paid plans
Brevo	300 emails a day, up to 100,000 contacts, Brevo branding	Generous sending; email, SMS and WhatsApp campaigns in one tool; basic CRM	Daily cap; flows enrol up to 2,000 contacts on Free
MailerLite	250 subscribers, 2,500 emails a month, 3 automations (since June 2026)	Clean editor, simple automations, landing pages	Sending locks if you go over the subscriber limit

Sources: Mailchimp and HubSpot pricing and help pages; Brevo and MailerLite limits as reported in an independent comparison validated in September 2026. Paid plans are priced in US dollars and change often.

How to choose

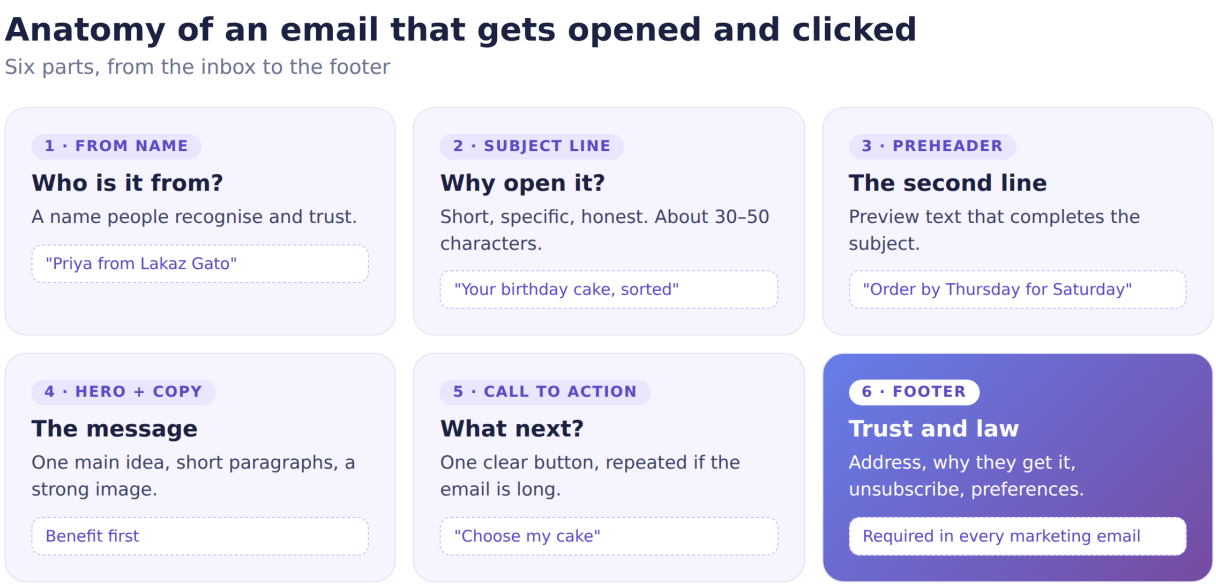
- **Mostly newsletters and a few automations, small list:** Mailchimp, MailerLite or Brevo.
- **Large list, low budget:** Brevo (daily cap but many contacts).
- **Sales process with quotes, calls and deals:** HubSpot free CRM, connected to your email tool if needed.
- **Online shop:** use the email tool that integrates best with your platform (Shopify, WooCommerce) for abandoned-cart and post-purchase flows (Week 16).
- **Email, SMS and WhatsApp together:** Brevo or another tool with all channels, so consent and history stay in one place.

> **Tip:** the tool matters less than the habits. A simple monthly newsletter sent for a year beats an expensive platform that nobody uses. Start free, prove results, then upgrade.

SECTION 10

Subject lines and preheaders

The from name, the subject line and the preheader (the preview text shown after the subject) decide whether your email is opened. You have a few words to earn attention in a busy inbox.



Ten rules for subject lines

1. **Be specific:** "3 cake ideas for a 5-year-old's party" beats "October newsletter".
2. **Keep it short:** many phones show only about 30–40 characters. Put the important words first.
3. **Lead with the benefit** for the reader, not the company.
4. **Use curiosity carefully:** intrigue is fine, clickbait is not. The email must deliver what the subject promises.
5. **Personalise when it helps:** first name or town, but not in every email.
6. **Create real urgency only:** "Ends Sunday" if it really ends Sunday.
7. **Avoid spam triggers:** ALL CAPS, many "!!!", "FREE $$$", misleading "RE:" or "FWD:".
8. **One emoji at most,** and test it: some audiences like it, others do not.
9. **Match the language** of the segment (English, French, a Kreol touch).
10. **Test:** A/B test subject lines on larger sends (Section 26).

Before and after

Weak	Better	Why
Newsletter October 2026	Divali sweets are back (pre-order by 25 Oct)	Specific, timely, clear action
Special offer!!!	Book direct: free breakfast for 2 in November	Clear benefit, no spammy punctuation
Lagon Bleu news	The 5 best snorkelling spots near Trou aux Biches	Useful content, local keywords
Join our webinar	Use AI to write your posts in 30 minutes (free webinar, 12 Nov)	Benefit + time + date

The preheader

If you leave the preheader empty, the inbox shows the first text of the email, often "View in browser" or "Having trouble reading this email?". Always write it. Use it to complete the subject: subject "Your birthday cake, sorted" + preheader "Choose a design, we deliver in Plaines Wilhems".

The from name

Use a name people recognise: the brand ("Lakaz Gato") or a person at the brand ("Priya at Lakaz Gato"). Keep it the same every time. Send from your own domain (hello@lakazgato.mu), never from a free Gmail or Hotmail address: bulk mail from free addresses fails authentication (Section 14).

SECTION 11

Writing the email: copy and call to action

Good email copy sounds like a helpful person, not a brochure. Most people scan, so make the main message and the action obvious within a few seconds.

A simple structure that works

1. **Hook:** one line that connects with the subject line and the reader’s situation.
2. **Value:** the tip, story, news or offer, in short paragraphs or 3–5 bullets.
3. **Proof:** a review, a photo of a real customer, a number.
4. **Call to action (CTA):** one main button that says exactly what happens next.
5. **Sign-off:** a real name and a friendly P.S. (the P.S. is often read).

Writing tips

- Write to one person ("you"), as if you were sending it to a single customer.
- One email, one main goal. If you need three goals, send three emails or use a newsletter layout with one clear main story.
- Short sentences and paragraphs of 1–3 lines; bold the key words.
- Use frameworks from Week 4: AIDA (Attention, Interest, Desire, Action) or PAS (Problem, Agitation, Solution).
- AI tools can draft subject lines and copy quickly: give them your audience, offer and tone, then edit the result so it sounds like you and check every fact and price.

Calls to action

Weak CTA	Strong CTA
Click here	See this month’s cakes
Submit	Book my free trial class
Learn more	Get the North Coast guide
Contact us	Ask us on WhatsApp

Use a button (not only a text link), with enough contrast and at least about 44 px high so it is easy to tap on a phone. Repeat the CTA at the end of longer emails. Every link should carry UTM parameters (utm_source=newsletter, utm_medium=email, utm_campaign=...) so GA4 can attribute visits and key events to the email (Week 2).

Example (Lakaz Gato, welcome email 1):
Subject: Welcome! Your 10 birthday cake ideas are inside
Preheader: Plus how ordering works (it takes 2 minutes)

Hi Anjali,
Thanks for joining. As promised, here are our 10 most-loved kids' birthday cakes, with prices from Rs 1,200. [Button: See the 10 ideas]
Ordering is simple: choose a design, message us on WhatsApp or order online, and pick up in Rose Hill or get it delivered.
See you soon, Priya
P.S. Order at least 3 days ahead for custom designs.

SECTION 12

Design, mobile and accessibility

Most people will read your email on a phone, often in dark mode. A simple, clean design that loads fast and is easy to tap works better than a complex poster.

Design rules

- **Single column** layout, around 600 px wide, with plenty of white space.
- **Readable text:** body text about 16 px on mobile, headings larger, good contrast.
- **Live text, not one big image:** many inboxes block images by default and screen readers cannot read text inside images. Keep important information (offer, date, price) in real text.
- **Alt text** on every image ("Chocolate unicorn cake, Rs 1,450").
- **Light images:** compress them (Week 2) so the email loads quickly on mobile data.
- **Brand consistency:** logo, colours and fonts from your brand guide (Week 4), but simple.
- **Dark mode:** use logos with a transparent background and test how colours change.
- **Footer:** business name and address, why the person receives the email, unsubscribe and preference links, social icons.

Test before you send

☐ Send a test to yourself and a colleague: Gmail app, Outlook, iPhone Mail.
☐ Read it on a phone, in light and dark mode.
☐ Click every link and button; check UTMs and that the landing page works on mobile.
☐ Check name personalisation has a fallback ("Hi there" if no first name).
☐ Check spelling, prices, dates, phone and WhatsApp numbers.
☐ Check the preview (subject + preheader) in the inbox.

Tip: Canva (Week 4) is great for email header images. Export as JPG or PNG, compress, then add the text in the email editor rather than inside the image.

SECTION 13

Step by step: your first campaign in Mailchimp

Mailchimp menus change from time to time, but the steps stay the same. Use the free plan to learn; switch to a paid plan or another tool when your list grows.

A. Set up the account and audience

1. Create an account at mailchimp.com with your business email. Turn on two-factor authentication in your profile security settings.
2. Complete your business details: name, physical address (required in the footer of every campaign) and website.
3. Go to **Audience**: you have one audience. In **Settings**, rename it, set the default from name and from email address, and add a reminder of how people joined ("You signed up on lakazgato.mu").
4. Add contact fields you will use (for example LANGUAGE, BIRTHDAY, TOWN) under audience fields.
5. Create tags for sources (source_website, source_shop, source_fair) and interests.
6. Import existing contacts only if they agreed to marketing. Use a CSV with email, first name, and a tag for the source.

B. Connect your domain

1. In the domain settings, add and verify your domain (lakazgato.mu) with a confirmation email.
2. Authenticate it: Mailchimp gives you DNS records (DKIM and related records) to add at your domain host. Then add a DMARC record (Section 14).
3. Wait for Mailchimp to show the domain as authenticated before your first big send.

C. Create a sign-up form

1. Use the form builder (hosted form, embedded form or pop-up) under the audience or sign-up forms area.
2. Keep fields to email, first name and language. Add your marketing permission text and privacy link.
3. Decide on double opt-in (recommended for public forms) and customise the confirmation and welcome messages.
4. Copy the form link for your Instagram bio, WhatsApp replies and QR codes; embed the form on your website.

D. Build and send a campaign

1. **Create** > Email. Name it with a clear convention ("2026-11 Divali newsletter").
2. **To:** choose the audience and, if needed, a segment or tag.
3. **From:** your name and domain email. **Subject** and **preview text** (preheader).
4. **Content:** pick a simple template; add your header image, copy, button and footer.
5. Turn on click tracking and add UTM parameters (or use the built-in Google Analytics link tracking).
6. **Send a test** and run the checks in Section 12.
7. **Schedule or send.** Note that scheduling may need a paid plan; on the free plan you can send immediately.

8. After 48 hours and again after 7 days, look at the report: delivery, clicks, unsubscribes, orders (Section 25).

> Remember the free plan limits: 250 contacts and 500 sends a month. Two campaigns to 250 people already use the full monthly allowance.

SECTION 14

Deliverability 1: authentication (SPF, DKIM, DMARC)

Deliverability is your ability to land in the inbox, not in spam. It depends on three things: proving who you are (authentication), your sender reputation, and how people react to your emails.



Record	What it does	How to set it up
SPF (Sender Policy Framework)	A DNS (Domain Name System) TXT record that lists which servers may send email for your domain	One SPF record per domain. Include your email host (Google Workspace, Microsoft 365) and your email tool if it asks for it.
DKIM (DomainKeys Identified Mail)	Adds a cryptographic signature to every email; inboxes check it with a public key in your DNS	Copy the DKIM records from your email tool into your DNS (often CNAME or TXT records).
DMARC (Domain-based Message Authentication, Reporting and Conformance)	Tells inboxes what to do when SPF or DKIM fail, and sends you reports	Start with: v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:dmarc@yourdomain.mu. Later move to p=quarantine, then p=reject.

Alignment: the detail that trips people up

DMARC passes only if SPF or DKIM passes **for the same domain as the one in the From address**. If you send as hello@lakazgato.mu but the DKIM signature is for the email tool's own domain, DMARC fails. That is why you must authenticate your own domain in Mailchimp, Brevo, HubSpot or MailerLite.

Who sets it up?

The DNS records are added where your domain is managed (your web host or domain registrar, for .mu domains often a local provider or agency). If you do not have access, send the records to your web developer. Check the result with your email tool's domain checker or free tools such as MXToolbox, and in Google Postmaster Tools once you send to many Gmail users.

```
Example DNS records for lakazgato.mu (illustrative)
TXT   lakazgato.mu         v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all
CNAME k1._domainkey        dkim.mailchimp-provided-value (copy from your tool)
TXT   _dmarc.lakazgato.mu  v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:dmarc@lakazgato.mu
```

SECTION 15

Deliverability 2: inbox rules, warm-up and list hygiene

Since 2024 the big mailbox providers have enforced clear rules for anyone sending marketing email. Gmail started enforcing more strictly from November 2025, with non-compliant messages slowed down or rejected. These rules protect your subscribers, and they protect you too.

Gmail and Yahoo sender requirements

Requirement	All senders	Bulk senders (5,000+ emails a day to Gmail)
Authentication	SPF or DKIM	SPF and DKIM, plus DMARC (at least p=none) aligned with the From domain
Infrastructure	Valid forward and reverse DNS, TLS encryption	Same
Unsubscribe	A clear way to unsubscribe	One-click unsubscribe (RFC 8058) in marketing emails, processed within 2 days
Spam complaint rate	Stay below 0.3%	Aim below 0.1%; never reach 0.3% (shown in Google Postmaster Tools)
Honest headers	No impersonation of Gmail or misleading From	Same

Source: Google sender guidelines as summarised by Red Sift; Yahoo publishes similar rules (authentication, one-click unsubscribe, spam rate below 0.3%). Microsoft requires SPF, DKIM and DMARC for domains sending more than 5,000 emails a day to Outlook.com, Hotmail and Live addresses.

A spam rate of 0.3% means 3 complaints for every 1,000 emails delivered. Once a sender is classed as a bulk sender by Google, that status does not go away even if volume drops. Most small Mauritian businesses send far less than 5,000 a day, but follow the bulk rules anyway: good email tools add one-click unsubscribe automatically, and authentication improves inbox placement for everyone.

Warming up a new domain or tool

Inboxes are suspicious of a new sender that suddenly sends thousands of emails. Build reputation gradually:

1. Authenticate the domain first (Section 14).
2. Start with your most engaged contacts: recent customers and people who signed up in the last few months.

3. Send to small batches at first, then increase volume step by step over a few weeks while watching bounces and complaints.
4. Keep a regular rhythm: sudden spikes after months of silence look suspicious.
5. Re-confirm old contacts (more than 12 months without contact) with a permission email before adding them to regular sends.

List hygiene: keep the list clean

Problem	What it means	What to do
Hard bounce	Permanent failure: the address does not exist	Remove immediately (most tools do it automatically)
Soft bounce	Temporary: full inbox, server down	Keep, but remove after repeated soft bounces
Inactive contacts	No opens or clicks for 6–12 months	Send a re-engagement sequence, then suppress those who do not respond
Spam traps	Old or fake addresses used to catch bad senders	Avoid bought lists, use double opt-in, clean inactive contacts
Typos and role addresses	gmial.com, info@, test@	Use form validation; check new imports
Duplicates	Same person in several lists	One audience with tags and segments

Signs your deliverability has a problem

- Open and click rates suddenly drop, especially for Gmail or Outlook addresses.
- Bounce rate above about 2% on a campaign, or complaints above 0.1%.
- Your own test emails land in spam or the Promotions tab changes to spam.
- Your email tool warns you about your account or pauses sending.

> **Tip:** the Gmail Promotions tab is not spam. Many people browse it when they are ready to shop. Focus on being authenticated, relevant and expected, rather than trying to "beat" the tab with tricks.

PART D

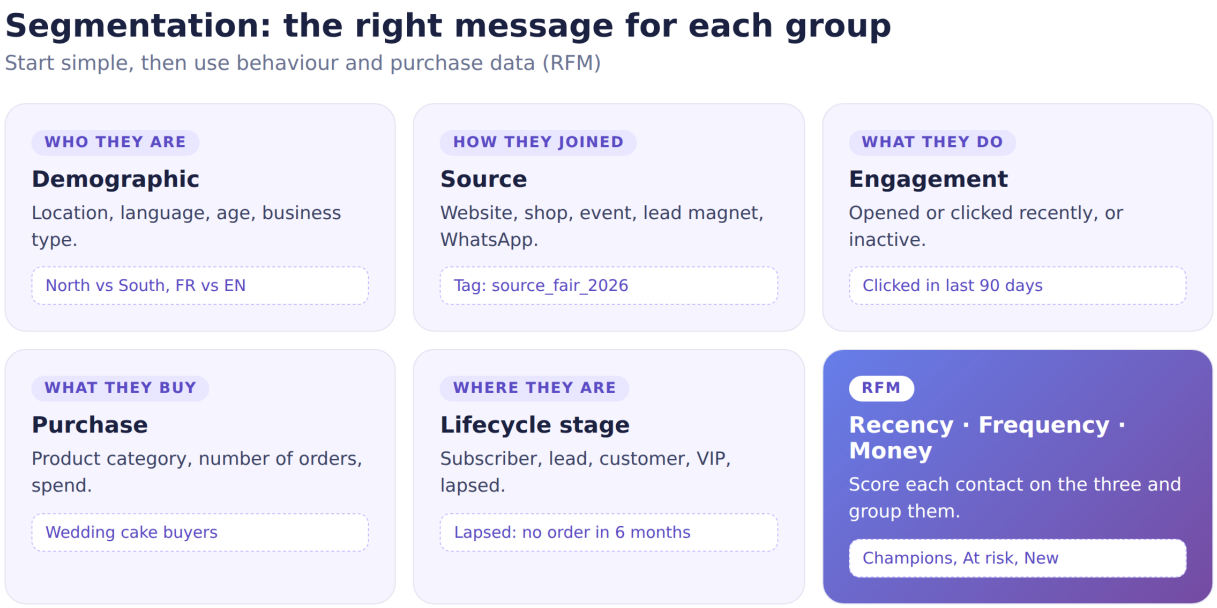
Segment & automate

Segmentation, personalisation, automated sequences, WhatsApp and SMS alongside email

SECTION 16

Segmentation: the right message for each group

Segmentation means splitting your list into groups that share something, so each group gets more relevant emails. Relevant emails get more clicks, fewer unsubscribes and fewer spam complaints.



Start with five simple segments

1. **New subscribers** (joined in the last 30 days): they get the welcome series.
2. **Customers vs non-customers:** different offers and messages.
3. **Engaged** (opened or clicked in the last 90 days) vs **inactive**.
4. **Interest or product category:** birthday cakes, wedding cakes, corporate orders.
5. **Language** or **location**, if relevant to your offer.

RFM: segment customers by what they buy

RFM stands for Recency (how recently they bought), Frequency (how often) and Monetary value (how much they spent). Give each customer a simple score from 1 to 3 on each, then group them. You will practise this with formulas in the Excel exercise.

Segment	Typical RFM pattern	What to send
Champions	Bought recently, often, high spend	Early access, VIP thank-you, referral invitation. No heavy discounts needed.
Loyal	Buy often, medium spend	New products, loyalty rewards, reviews request
New customers	First purchase recently	Post-purchase series, second-order incentive
At risk	Used to buy often, nothing recently	Win-back: "We miss you", personal offer, feedback survey
Lost / hibernating	Long ago, once, low spend	One last re-engagement attempt, then suppress

How to build a segment (any tool)

1. Decide the question: "Who has bought a birthday cake in the last 12 months but not in the last 3?"
2. Make sure the data exists: a tag, a field or a purchase integration.
3. In the tool, create a segment with conditions (AND / OR) and save it, so it updates automatically.
4. Check the count and a sample of contacts before sending.
5. Name it clearly: "Customers – birthday – 3 to 12 months".

Example: a segmentation strategy for Lakaz Gato

Segment	Conditions in the tool	What they receive
New subscribers	Joined in the last 14 days	Welcome series only; excluded from promotions
Birthday parents	Tag interest_kids OR bought a kids' cake	Theme ideas, birthday reminder 10 days before the child's birthday
Wedding leads	Tag wedding_lead AND not customer	Nurture: tastings, real weddings, price guide; CRM deal for each
Office customers	Company field not empty OR tag b2b	Event and end-of-year office offers, quote button
VIP champions	RFM segment = Champions	Early access to seasonal menus, referral offer
Inactive	No click in 180 days AND no order in 12 months	Win-back series, then suppressed

Illustrative example. Your segments depend on the data you really collect.

> **Tip:** in Mailchimp, segments are built from tags, fields, campaign activity and purchase data; in HubSpot they are called **lists** (active lists update automatically, static lists do not). Brevo and MailerLite use segments and groups.

SECTION 17

Personalisation that feels human

Personalisation means changing part of the email for each person: their name, but more importantly the content, the offer and the timing. Done well, it feels like good service. Done badly, it feels creepy or broken.

Level	Example	What you need
1. Name	"Hi Anjali"	First name field, with a fallback
2. Segment content	Families see kids' cakes, couples see wedding cakes	Interest tags or segments
3. Dynamic blocks	Different block for Port Louis office contacts vs home customers	Conditional content feature in the tool
4. Behaviour	"You looked at our snorkelling tours. Here are 3 dates"	Website tracking or e-commerce integration
5. Timing	Birthday email 10 days before the child's birthday	Date field and an automation

Merge tags

Email tools insert personal data with merge tags (Mailchimp: *|FNAME|*; HubSpot: personalisation tokens; Brevo: {{ contact.FIRSTNAME }}). Always set a default value so an empty field shows "Hi there" instead of "Hi ,".

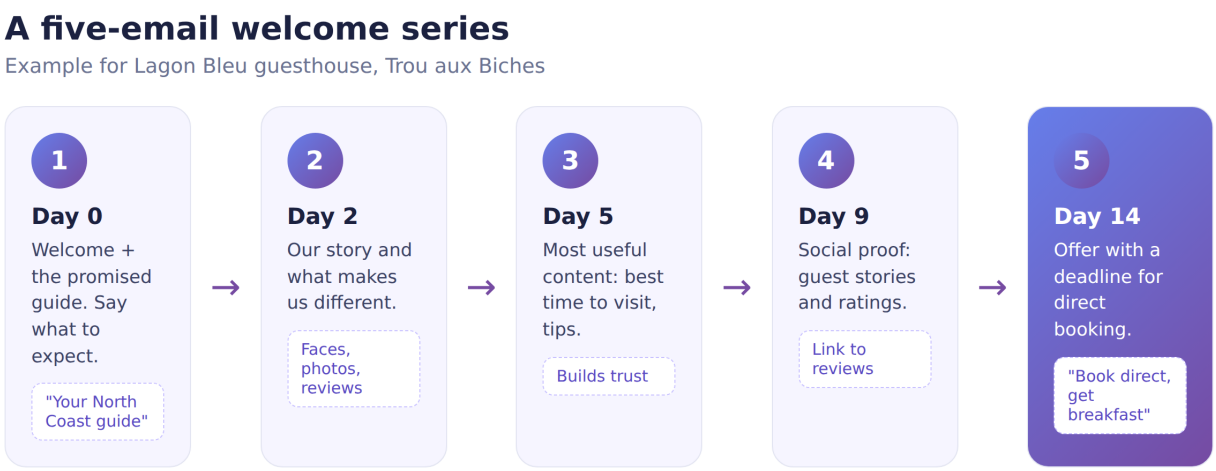
Do and don’t

- **Do** use data people gave you knowingly (birthday, interests, language) to be more helpful.
- **Do** let people choose topics and frequency in a preference centre.
- **Don’t** mention sensitive information (health, religion, finances) in emails or subject lines.
- **Don’t** over-personalise: "We saw you looked at this 4 times last night" feels like spying.

SECTION 18

Automation sequences that work every day

Automations send the right email at the right moment for each person, without you pressing "send". Set up a few good ones and they will keep working for months.



The four essential automations

Automation	Trigger	Emails and timing	Goal
Welcome series	Joins the list	3–5 emails over 2 weeks: welcome + promise; story; best content; proof; offer	Trust and first purchase
Post-purchase	Order, booking or check-out	Thank you (day 0–1); tips / how to use (day 3); review request (day 7); next order idea (day 30)	Satisfaction, reviews, repeat purchase
Birthday or anniversary	Date field (birthday, membership date, wedding date)	1 email 7–10 days before, reminder on the day	Delight and a reason to buy
Win-back / re-engagement	No order (or no click) for X months	3 emails over 2–3 weeks: "we miss you"; best offer; "should we stop writing?"	Reactivate or clean the list

Worked example: Lakaz Gato welcome series

#	Timing	Goal	Subject line	Preheader	CTA
1	Immediately	Deliver the guide, set expectations	Welcome! Your 10 birthday cake ideas are inside	Plus how ordering works (2 minutes)	See the 10 ideas
2	Day 2	Story and trust	How a Rose Hill kitchen became Lakaz Gato	Meet Priya and the team	Watch our story
3	Day 5	Most useful content	How to choose the right cake size (and save)	A simple guide by number of guests	Use the size guide
4	Day 9	Social proof	"The best cake my son ever had"	Real parties, real reviews	Read the reviews
5	Day 14	First order	Your welcome gift: 10% off ends Sunday	For your first order, online or on WhatsApp	Order my cake

Exit condition: anyone who orders leaves the series and enters the post-purchase flow. Illustrative example.

Other useful automations

- **Abandoned cart:** 1 hour, 24 hours and 72 hours after a basket is left (e-commerce only).
- **Lead nurture:** after a brochure download or a quote request, 4–6 educational emails, then a call to book a meeting.
- **Event sequence:** confirmation, reminder 1 day before, reminder 1 hour before, replay and survey after.
- **Pre-arrival (hotels):** 7 days before arrival: transfers, restaurant booking, activities; post-stay: thank you and review.

Writing a sequence: rules of thumb

- Each email has one job and leads naturally to the next.
- Use an exit condition: stop the sequence when the person buys or books.
- Exclude people in a sequence from big promotions to avoid sending two emails on the same day.
- Review every automation every 3–6 months: prices, links and offers change.

SECTION 19

Step by step: automations in Mailchimp

Mailchimp builds automations as flows: a trigger (starting point) followed by actions such as send email, wait (time delay), conditions (if/else) and tags. Multi-step flows need a paid plan (Essentials allows flows of up to 4 steps; Standard adds more steps and flow templates).

Build a welcome series

1. Go to **Automations** and choose to build a new flow (or start from a welcome template).
2. Choose the trigger: "Signs up" (joins the audience), or "Tag added" if you tag subscribers by lead magnet.
3. Add the first action: **Send email**. Write email 1 (welcome + promise). Set it to send immediately.
4. Add a **Time delay** (for example 2 days), then email 2. Repeat for emails 3–5, within your plan's step limit.
5. Add a condition if your plan allows it: "Has purchased?" If yes, exit the flow or move to the post-purchase flow.

6. Set the flow settings: from name, UTM tracking, and whether contacts can enter more than once.
7. Test with your own email address (sign up through the real form), then turn the flow on.
8. After 30 days, look at each email's clicks and conversions and improve the weakest email first.

Build a birthday email

1. Make sure you collect a birthday field (Mailchimp has a birthday field type: month and day only, which is enough).
2. Create a flow with a **date-based** trigger: "Contact's birthday" (or any date field), with how many days before to send.
3. Write a warm email with a real gift: "Your birthday cupcake is on us this month".
4. Turn it on. It will run every year for every contact with a birthday.

Build a win-back flow

1. If your shop is connected, use purchase activity ("has not purchased in 90 days"). If not, use a tag you update from your sales records (for example "lapsed_6m").
2. Email 1: "We miss you" + what is new. Email 2 (one week later): a personal offer with a deadline. Email 3: "Should we stop writing?" with a button to stay subscribed.
3. Contacts who do not click any of the 3 emails: unsubscribe or archive them to protect deliverability (archived contacts do not count towards your plan's contact limit in Mailchimp).

> Check your plan before you design a complex flow. On the free plan you will mainly send single campaigns; test automations on a trial or on a free plan of another tool (Brevo or MailerLite) if needed.

SECTION 20

Step by step: forms and follow-ups in HubSpot (free)

HubSpot's free tools are a CRM first. They include forms, marketing email (2,000 sends a month), a live chat widget, landing pages and a meetings link. Multi-step workflows are part of paid plans, but you can still automate the first follow-up and organise every lead.

Create a form that feeds the CRM

1. Go to **Marketing > Forms** and create an embedded form (or a pop-up form).
2. Add fields: email, first name, phone (optional), a dropdown "What are you interested in?".
3. Add the consent checkbox for marketing communications and the privacy text (HubSpot lets you add GDPR-style consent options).
4. In the form options, set a thank-you message or redirect, and turn on the **follow-up email** if your account offers it (the free tools include a single automated email action).
5. Publish: embed it on your website or share the hosted form link. Each submission creates or updates a contact with the form as its source.

Send a marketing email

1. Go to **Marketing > Email**, create a regular email and choose a template (free accounts have a few templates).
2. Set from name, subject and preview text; write and design the email.

3. Choose recipients: an active list (segment) of contacts who opted in.
4. Send a test, then send. Look at opens, clicks and contacts who clicked; you can follow up personally with high-value leads.

Make up for missing workflows

- Use **tasks** and reminders on each contact or deal for manual follow-ups ("Call Mr Ramdin on Tuesday").
- Use **sequences of personal emails** written as templates and sent one by one for a small number of leads.
- Connect HubSpot to another email tool (for example Mailchimp) if you need automated nurture flows, or upgrade when the volume justifies it.

SECTION 21

WhatsApp and SMS alongside email

In Mauritius, WhatsApp is often where the conversation and the sale actually happen. The best results come from using each channel for what it does best and keeping consent and contact data in one place.

	Email	WhatsApp	SMS
Best for	Rich content, newsletters, documents, receipts, longer sequences	Conversations, quick questions, orders, reminders, personal service	Short urgent alerts, codes, reminders for people without smartphones
Tone	Planned, branded	Personal, fast, conversational	Very short, factual
Cost	Low per message	WhatsApp Business app: free; Business Platform (API): pay per delivered template message	Pay per message
Risk	Spam folder if irrelevant	Blocked or reported if spammy; can affect your number	Annoying if frequent

How WhatsApp works for businesses

- **WhatsApp Business app** (Week 5): free, for one phone or a few linked devices. Labels, quick replies, catalogue, greeting and away messages, and broadcast lists (only people who saved your number receive broadcasts).
- **WhatsApp Business Platform (API)**: through a provider or tools like Brevo or HubSpot integrations. Since 1 July 2025 Meta charges per delivered template message (marketing, utility, authentication), with rates by country. Replies inside the 24-hour customer service window opened by the customer are free.
- **Opt-in:** ask clearly and record it. "Tick here to receive order updates and occasional offers on WhatsApp."

Combining the channels

1. Email the full newsletter or booking confirmation; use WhatsApp (Channel, Status or a reminder) for the short version.
2. Add a WhatsApp click-to-chat button (wa.me link) in emails for questions.
3. Record WhatsApp orders in the CRM, so the customer’s history is complete and they enter the right email automations.

> **In Mauritius:** a guesthouse can send a pre-arrival email with all details and a map, and a WhatsApp message on the arrival day: "Hello Mr Dupont, we are ready for you. Reply here if you need a taxi from the airport." Guests love the personal touch, and the email keeps everything in writing.

SMS in practice

- **Keep it short:** one standard SMS is 160 characters (fewer if you use special characters). Put the business name at the start.
- **Use it for what is urgent or time-bound:** appointment reminders, delivery today, last day of an offer for VIP customers.
- **Always add a way to stop:** "Reply STOP to unsubscribe" or a short opt-out instruction, and honour it in every tool.
- **Mind the timing:** no marketing SMS late in the evening or very early in the morning.
- **Track it:** short links with UTM parameters (utm_medium=sms) so GA4 shows the visits and key events.

Tools such as Brevo let you send SMS and WhatsApp campaigns from the same contact list as your emails, using credits. Local SMS gateway providers in Mauritius also offer bulk SMS; compare prices, delivery reports and how they handle opt-outs.

PART E

CRM & measurement

CRM basics, pipelines, lead scoring,
email metrics, benchmarks,
A/B testing and reporting

SECTION 22

CRM basics: contacts, companies, deals, pipelines

A CRM is the memory of your business. Instead of information spread across notebooks, Excel files, phones and inboxes, every contact and every conversation is in one place that the whole team can see.

The main objects in a CRM

Object	What it holds	Example
Contact	A person: name, email, phone, source, lifecycle stage, history of emails, calls, notes	Anjali Ramdin, Rose Hill, joined via website
Company	An organisation, linked to its contacts	Island Tech Ltd, Ebène (orders cakes for staff events)
Deal	A potential sale with a value, a stage and a close date	"Island Tech – Christmas party – Rs 18,000"
Pipeline	The sequence of stages a deal goes through	New enquiry → Quote sent → Tasting → Won / Lost
Activity / task	Calls, emails, meetings, notes, reminders	Call back Friday 10:00
Property	A field you can filter and report on	Source, language, budget, event date

Lifecycle stages vs deal stages

These two ideas are often confused. **Lifecycle stage** describes the whole relationship with a contact (where they are with your business). **Deal stage** describes one specific sale in your pipeline. One customer can have several deals over time.



HubSpot's default lifecycle stages are Subscriber, Lead, Marketing Qualified Lead (MQL), Sales Qualified Lead (SQL), Opportunity, Customer, Evangelist and Other. MQL means marketing thinks the lead is a good fit and interested; SQL means sales has confirmed it is worth a direct sales conversation.

Designing a pipeline

1. List the real steps between first contact and payment in your business. Keep 5–7 stages.

2. Define each stage with a clear, checkable rule ("Quote sent = PDF quote emailed").
3. Give each stage a rough probability of closing, to forecast revenue.
4. Decide who owns each deal and what the next step is. No deal without a next step and a date.
5. Review the pipeline every week: move, update or close deals honestly.

Business	Example pipeline stages
Wedding cakes	Enquiry → Call done → Tasting booked → Quote sent → Deposit paid (won) / Lost
Training company	Lead → Discovery call → Proposal sent → Negotiation → Signed (won) / Lost
Guesthouse (groups)	Request → Availability checked → Offer sent → Deposit received (won) / Lost

SECTION 23

Step by step: set up the HubSpot free CRM

HubSpot's free CRM is enough for many small Mauritian businesses: up to 2 users, contacts, companies, deals, a pipeline, tasks, email tracking and reports. Limits on new free accounts change, so check Settings > Account & Billing > Usage & Limits.

1. **Sign up** at hubspot.com with your business email; choose the free tools. Turn on two-factor authentication.
2. **Company settings:** name, address, currency (MUR), time zone (Indian/Mauritius), logo and brand colours.
3. **Users:** invite your colleague (free tools allow up to 2 users). Give each person only the access they need.
4. **Properties:** create a few custom properties you really need, such as Preferred language, Lead source detail, Event date. Free accounts have a limited number of custom properties, so choose carefully.
5. **Import contacts:** Contacts > Import > a CSV file with email, first name, last name, phone, company, source and marketing consent status. Mark people without marketing consent as non-marketing contacts.
6. **Pipeline:** Settings > Objects > Deals > Pipelines. Rename the default stages to match your process and set the win probability for each.
7. **Connect your inbox:** connect Gmail or Outlook so emails with contacts are logged automatically. Install the HubSpot sales extension to track opens of one-to-one emails.
8. **Forms and chat:** add a HubSpot form and the chat widget to your website (Section 20), so new leads land in the CRM.
9. **Daily routine:** start each day in the Tasks view; after each call, add a note and the next task.
10. **Reports:** use the dashboards for new contacts by source, deals created and won, and pipeline value.

Tip: the first 30 days decide whether a CRM survives. Agree three team rules: every enquiry becomes a contact, every opportunity becomes a deal, and every deal always has a next task with a date.

In Mauritius: many Mauritian SMEs take enquiries by WhatsApp, phone and Facebook. Log them in the CRM at the end of each day, with the source ("WhatsApp", "Facebook", "Walk-in"). After 3 months you will know exactly which channels bring your best customers.

SECTION 24

Lead scoring: an introduction

Lead scoring gives each lead points, based on who they are and what they do, so sales time goes to the people most likely to buy. Week 15 (marketing automation) covers this in depth; here are the basics.

Type of signal	Examples	Points (example)
Fit (who they are)	Business in your target sector; decision maker; located in Mauritius; budget fits	+5 to +15
Engagement (what they do)	Opened 3 emails in a month; clicked pricing; visited the pricing page twice; downloaded a brochure	+3 to +10
Intent (strong buying signals)	Requested a quote; booked a call; replied to an email	+20
Negative signals	Student or competitor email; unsubscribed; no activity for 90 days	-10 to -20

Points are examples to start from. Adjust them by checking which past leads became customers.

How to start without special software

1. Agree with sales what a "good lead" looks like (fit) and which actions show interest (engagement and intent).
2. Give points to 6–10 criteria only. Keep it simple.
3. Set a threshold: for example 40 points = MQL, passed to sales for a call within 24 hours.
4. Calculate it in a spreadsheet or a custom number property in the CRM, updated weekly.
5. After 2–3 months, compare scores with real outcomes and adjust.

Automatic lead scoring is mainly available in paid plans of HubSpot and other tools. The logic is the same: you decide the rules; the tool does the counting.

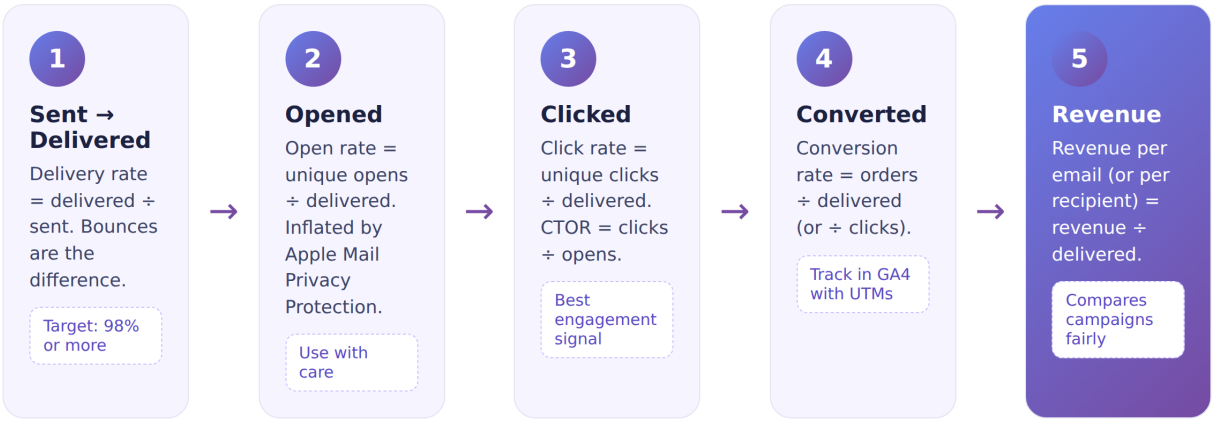
SECTION 25

Email metrics and benchmarks

Measure what matters for the business. Opens are useful for spotting problems, but clicks, conversions and revenue tell you whether email works.

The email funnel and its metrics

Every step has a rate. Clicks and conversions matter more than opens.



Metric	Formula	What it tells you
Delivery rate	Delivered ÷ sent	List quality and technical health. Aim for 98% or more.
Bounce rate	Bounced ÷ sent (hard + soft)	Old or fake addresses. Investigate if above about 2%.
Open rate	Unique opens ÷ delivered	Subject line and sender trust, but inflated (see below)
Click rate (CTR)	Unique clicks ÷ delivered	How many people found the content worth acting on
Click-to-open rate (CTOR)	Unique clicks ÷ unique opens	How good the content and CTA were for those who opened
Conversion rate	Conversions ÷ delivered (or ÷ clicks, say which)	Business result: orders, bookings, sign-ups
Unsubscribe rate	Unsubscribes ÷ delivered	Relevance and frequency
Spam complaint rate	Complaints ÷ delivered	Danger signal. Keep below 0.1%.
Revenue per email (per recipient)	Revenue ÷ delivered	Compares campaigns of different sizes fairly
List growth rate	(New subscribers − unsubscribes − bounces/cleaned) ÷ list size at start	Is the list really growing?

Worked example: one Lakaz Gato campaign

Sent 2,000 · bounced 40 · unique opens 880 · unique clicks 98 · orders 12 · revenue Rs 21,600 · unsubscribes 4 (illustrative numbers).

Metric	Calculation	Result
Delivered	2,000 − 40	1,960
Delivery rate	1,960 ÷ 2,000	98.0%
Open rate	880 ÷ 1,960	44.9%
Click rate	98 ÷ 1,960	5.0%
Click-to-open rate	98 ÷ 880	11.1%
Conversion rate (of delivered)	12 ÷ 1,960	0.61%
Conversion rate (of clicks)	12 ÷ 98	12.2%
Unsubscribe rate	4 ÷ 1,960	0.20%
Revenue per recipient	Rs 21,600 ÷ 1,960	Rs 11.02

The Apple Mail Privacy Protection caveat

Since 2021, Apple Mail Privacy Protection (MPP) can pre-load emails for Apple Mail users, which records an "open" even if the person never read the email. This inflates open rates and makes them unreliable for decisions such as "who is engaged" or A/B tests on subject lines. Use clicks, replies and conversions as your main engagement signals, and treat open rate as a rough trend only.

Benchmarks

Industry (MailerLite, Dec 2024–Nov 2025)	Open rate	Click rate	CTOR	Unsub.
All industries (median)	43.46%	2.09%	6.81%	0.22%
Travel and transportation	30.10%	1.68%	6.34%	0.13%
Restaurants and cafés	44.32%	1.06%	3.28%	0.39%
Retail	37.47%	1.27%	4.51%	0.22%
E-commerce	32.67%	1.07%	4.01%	0.18%
Health and fitness	47.81%	1.45%	4.45%	0.30%
Beauty and personal care	38.40%	0.95%	3.91%	0.23%

Source: MailerLite email marketing benchmarks 2025. Mailchimp's benchmarks (data as of December 2023) give an all-users average of 35.63% open rate, 2.62% click rate and 0.22% unsubscribe rate; Education and Training: 35.64% open, 3.02% click. Both sources warn that MPP inflates open rates.

> **Tip:** your own history is the best benchmark. Compare each campaign with your last 6 months, and the same segment with the same segment.

SECTION 26

A/B testing

An A/B test (split test) sends two versions of an email to two random groups to find out which works better. Over time, small improvements add up.

How to run a good test

1. **One hypothesis:** "A subject line with the price will get more clicks than one without."
2. **One variable** at a time: subject line, from name, CTA text, image, send time or offer.
3. **Pick the winning metric before you start:** click rate or conversion rate (not opens, because of MPP).
4. **Enough people:** with small lists, test on the whole list split 50/50 and repeat the test several times. With larger lists, test on 20–30% and send the winner to the rest.
5. **Wait long enough** (at least several hours, ideally 24 hours) before choosing the winner.
6. **Record results** in a test log and apply what you learn.

Reading the result: uplift

Uplift = (rate of B − rate of A) ÷ rate of A. Example: version A has a 2.0% click rate, version B 2.6%. Uplift = (2.6 − 2.0) ÷ 2.0 = 30%. With small groups, differences can be due to chance. If A and B are within a few clicks of each other, call it a draw and test again.

Test idea	Version A	Version B
Subject line	Our Divali sweets are back	Divali sweets from Rs 350: pre-order now
CTA	See the menu	Choose my sweets box
From name	Lakaz Gato	Priya at Lakaz Gato
Send time	Tuesday 7:30	Tuesday 12:30
Offer	10% off	Free delivery

In Mailchimp, A/B testing is available on paid plans (multivariate testing on higher plans). HubSpot offers A/B testing of marketing emails in paid Marketing Hub plans. Brevo and MailerLite also offer A/B tests; check your plan.

SECTION 27

Reporting, GA4 tracking and data governance

Your email tool reports what happens in the inbox. GA4 (Week 2) shows what happens afterwards on your website. You need both to prove the value of email.

Track email in GA4

1. Tag every link with UTM parameters: utm_source=newsletter, utm_medium=email, utm_campaign=2026_11_divali (lowercase, consistent; see the Week 2 naming rules).
2. Many tools can add UTMs automatically; check that they follow your naming rules.
3. In GA4, the default channel group "Email" shows sessions, engaged sessions and key events from these links.
4. Mark important actions as key events (purchase, generate_lead, booking) so you can see email conversions and revenue.
5. Build a simple Data Studio dashboard: list size, campaigns sent, click rate, conversions and revenue from email, by month.

Monthly email report (one page)

Section	Content
List health	Size, new subscribers, unsubscribes, bounces, growth rate, % engaged in last 90 days
Campaigns	Each send: delivered, click rate, CTOR, unsubscribe rate, conversions, revenue
Automations	Each flow: people entered, click rate, conversions, revenue
Learning	Best and worst email and why; A/B test results
Next month	3 actions: what to keep, improve or stop

Governance: protect the list and the data

- At least two admins on the email tool and the CRM; two-factor authentication for everyone.
- A shared account owned by the business (not an employee’s personal email).
- A naming convention for campaigns, segments, tags and properties.
- A documented consent process: forms, wording, where proof is stored, how unsubscribes and objections are handled (Section 4).
- Register with the Data Protection Office as a controller if required, and keep a simple record of what personal data you hold and why.
- A data clean-up every quarter: duplicates, bounces, inactive contacts, old properties.
- If someone leaves the company, remove their access the same day.

PART F

Put it to work

A case study, your Email Strategy, templates, checklists and glossary

SECTION 28

Case study: a guesthouse builds its direct-booking list

"Lagon Bleu" is a fictional but realistic 12-room guesthouse in Trou aux Biches. Most bookings came through online travel agencies, which take a commission. The owner wanted more direct and repeat bookings, and had 1,900 guest email addresses from past stays, with no clear consent for marketing.

1. Starting point

- Guest emails stored in the booking system and an old Excel file; no newsletter for three years.
- No domain authentication; emails sent from a Gmail address.
- Enquiries by WhatsApp, Facebook and email, followed up from memory.

2. What they did (months 1–2)

- **Consent first:** did not import the 1,900 old addresses into the newsletter. Older addresses were not used for marketing. From then on, every guest saw an unticked newsletter checkbox at booking and check-in, and the post-stay service email included an optional "Join our newsletter" link.
- **Domain and tool:** created hello@lagonbleu.mu, set up SPF, DKIM and DMARC (p=none), chose Brevo for email and WhatsApp, and HubSpot free CRM for group requests.
- **Lead magnet:** "The North Coast insider guide" (PDF) with a pop-up on the website and a QR code in each room.
- **Segments:** language (English / French), past guests vs prospects, couples vs families, country.
- **Automations:** 5-email welcome series (Section 18), pre-arrival email 7 days before, post-stay thank you + review request, anniversary email one year after the stay.

3. Results after 6 months (illustrative)

KPI	Before	After 6 months
Opted-in subscribers	0	1,140
Average click rate (campaigns)	–	3.4%
Welcome series: subscribers who booked within 60 days	–	4.1%
Unsubscribe rate per campaign	–	0.25%
Direct bookings per month	9	17
Revenue from email (GA4 key events + CRM)	Rs 0	Rs 1.24 million over 6 months
Group requests followed up within 24 h	About half	100% (CRM tasks)

What made the difference: a useful lead magnet, clear consent, a welcome series that sold the experience before the offer, and a CRM that made sure no group request was forgotten. The anniversary email ("One year ago you were here...") with a returning-guest offer became the best-performing email by revenue per recipient.

> **The lesson:** start with permission and usefulness. A smaller list of guests who want to hear from you produces more bookings, fewer complaints and better deliverability than a large list of people who never asked.

SECTION 29

Exercises and your Email Strategy

Your Week 10 deliverable is an **Email Strategy**: an email marketing plan with a 5-email sequence and a segmentation strategy. Work on a real business: your own, your employer's or one you know well.

Exercise A · List building and consent audit (45 min)

List every place where the business collects emails or phone numbers. For each: is there a clear opt-in, what is promised, where is proof stored, is there an unsubscribe? Design one lead magnet and the sign-up form text (Sections 4 and 6).

Exercise B · Set up a free account and a first campaign (60 min)

Create a free Mailchimp, Brevo or MailerLite account (or HubSpot free). Create a sign-up form, add 3–5 test contacts (yourself and classmates who agree), tag them, and send a test newsletter that follows Sections 10–12. Take screenshots of the form, the email and the report.

Exercise C · Segmentation and a welcome automation (60 min)

Define 4–6 segments with the exact conditions you would use in the tool (Section 16). Build a welcome flow (or document it step by step if your plan does not allow it) following Section 19.

Exercise D · Excel exercise (90 min)

Download the Week 10 Excel file: campaign metrics, list health, RFM segmentation with formulas, an A/B test and a sequence plan. Scored out of 20.

Deliverable: the Email Strategy

Part	Content
1. Business and objectives	Summary, value promise and 2–3 SMART email objectives
2. Audience and consent	Personas, where contacts come from, opt-in wording, unsubscribe and proof of consent
3. List building plan	Lead magnet, forms, pop-up, in-store and WhatsApp opt-in, monthly growth target
4. Segmentation strategy	4–6 segments with conditions, and what each receives
5. The 5-email sequence	Trigger, timing, goal, subject line, preheader, main message and CTA for each email; full copy of email 1
6. Calendar	3-month campaign calendar plus automations
7. Tools and deliverability	Email tool and CRM, domain authentication, list hygiene rules
8. Measurement	KPIs and targets, UTM convention, monthly report

Submit the Email Strategy (Google Doc or PDF link, 6–10 pages) on the learning platform, Module 10 exercises.

TEMPLATES

Copy-and-use templates

5-email sequence planner

#	Day / trigger	Goal	Subject line	Preheader	Main message	CTA
1	Day 0					
2						
3						
4						
5						

Segmentation plan

Segment name	Conditions (tool rules)	Size	What they receive	Frequency

Sign-up form wording

[Benefit headline] Get [what] every [frequency].
First name · Email · [Language: English / Français]
☐ Yes, I would like to receive emails from [Business] about [topics]. I can unsubscribe at any time. See our [privacy notice].
[Button: Send me the guide]

Re-engagement email

Subject: Should we stop writing, [First name]?
Preheader: One click to stay, or we will say goodbye

Hi [First name], we have not seen you open our emails for a while. We only want to write to people who enjoy hearing from us. [Button: Yes, keep me subscribed] If we do not hear from you, we will remove you from our list in 14 days. Thank you for being part of [Business].

SECTION 30

Checklists, mistakes and glossary

Before every campaign

- ☐ Right segment selected; people in active sequences excluded if needed
- ☐ From name and domain email; subject line and preheader written
- ☐ One main goal and one clear CTA
- ☐ Links tested, UTMs added, landing page works on mobile
- ☐ Personalisation fallbacks; alt text on images
- ☐ Footer with address and unsubscribe
- ☐ Tested on phone, desktop, light and dark mode
- ☐ Results check booked for 48 hours and 7 days later

Email programme set-up

- ☐ Domain authenticated: SPF, DKIM, DMARC
- ☐ Sign-up forms with consent wording and privacy link
- ☐ Welcome, post-purchase, birthday and win-back automations
- ☐ Segments and tags defined; naming convention agreed
- ☐ CRM with pipeline stages, owners and tasks
- ☐ Two admins and two-factor authentication on every tool
- ☐ Monthly report and quarterly list clean-up in the diary

Mistakes to avoid

Mistake	Do this instead
Buying or importing lists without consent	Grow an opt-in list with a lead magnet
Sending from a Gmail or Hotmail address	Use your own authenticated domain
Only promotions	Mostly useful content, some offers
One big image with all the text	Live text, light images, alt text
Judging success by open rate	Clicks, conversions and revenue per email
Same email to everyone	Segments and simple personalisation
Never cleaning the list	Re-engagement, then suppress inactive contacts
Leads followed up "from memory"	CRM with deals and tasks

Glossary

Term	Meaning
ESP	Email Service Provider: the tool that sends bulk email (Mailchimp, Brevo...)
CRM	Customer Relationship Management: the database of contacts, companies and deals
Opt-in / double opt-in	Active agreement to receive email / agreement confirmed by clicking a link
Lead magnet	A free, useful item offered in exchange for an email address
Segment	A group of contacts filtered by conditions, updated automatically
Automation / flow / workflow	Emails or actions triggered by a contact’s behaviour or a date
Preheader	Preview text shown after the subject line in the inbox
SPF, DKIM, DMARC	DNS records that authenticate email from your domain
Hard / soft bounce	Permanent / temporary delivery failure
CTOR	Click-to-open rate: unique clicks ÷ unique opens
MPP	Apple Mail Privacy Protection, which inflates open rates
RFM	Recency, Frequency, Monetary value: a way to segment customers
Lifecycle stage	Where a contact is in the relationship (subscriber, lead, customer...)
MQL / SQL	Marketing / Sales Qualified Lead
Pipeline / deal stage	The steps a sale goes through / the current step of one deal
Lead scoring	Points given to leads by fit and behaviour to prioritise sales effort
A/B test	Sending two versions to random groups to see which works better
Uplift	Relative improvement of B over A: (B − A) ÷ A